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“VIKSIT GOA BY 2037”

Goa Chief Minister Pramod Pandurang Sawant talks about initiatives to make the Goa 2037 vision a reality, diversify the state's revenue sources away from tourism, and why the GST system needs some tweaks

BY SIDDHARTH ZARABI

BT CAUGHT UP with Goa Chief Minister Pramod Pandurang Sawant, 52, at Sai Nursing Institute in Harvale, nestled in his home constituency of Sanquelim in North Goa, on a quiet Sunday evening. Now serving a second term, Sawant, an ayurvedic doctor with a master's in social work, was one of India's youngest chief ministers when he first took office in 2019 after the passing away of his predecessor, Manohar Parrikar. Rooted in the ideological framework of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh and a key face of the Bharatiya Janata Party in the coastal state, Sawant led the party to a successful re-election in 2022. Today, he is busy crafting a growth road map for Goa, India's smallest state by area but among the richest by per capita income, to punch above its weight.

In an exclusive interview with *Siddharth Zarabi*, Sawant spoke on his government's development agenda, revival of the mining industry, the future of tourism, among other issues. Edited excerpts: